

QIUHAO (BRAD) ZHAO

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Geographic information science (GIS) · Spatiotemporal machine learning · Multimodal big data & large language models · Tourism geography · Urban sustainability · Health geography

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Geology (Resources, Environment & Regional Planning)

Sep. 2022 – Present

Zhejiang University, School of Earth Sciences | Advisor: Prof. Pingbin Jin

GPA: 3.80/4.0 | Rank: 7/170 (4.1%)

B.S. in Human Geography & Urban-Rural Planning

Sep. 2018 – Jun. 2022

Zhejiang University, School of Earth Sciences | GPA: 3.83/4.0 | Rank: 3/19 (15.8%)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant — Zhejiang University (Tourism Planning & Big Data Lab)

Aug. 2021 – Present

School of Earth Sciences | Advisor: Prof. Pingbin Jin

Spatiotemporal Evolution and Drivers of Tourism Competitiveness: Spatiotemporal ML & Multimodal Data

- Fused remote-sensing imagery, social-media text/images, and POI data into a tourism competitiveness framework; built ML pipelines (XGBoost, LightGBM, CatBoost, GNNWR) to quantify spatiotemporal variation in competitiveness drivers.
- Participated in 5 tourism planning and resource-survey projects, including the Hangzhou tourism resource census (district-team leader, Fuyang & Gongshu) and Chizhou comprehensive tourism planning.

Joint-Training Ph.D. Researcher — Hong Kong Polytechnic University

Sep. 2024 – Jun. 2026

School of Hotel and Tourism Management | Ranked #1 worldwide (ShanghaiRanking)

Social Equity in Sustainable Dining Access in Hong Kong: LLMs & Multimodal Data

- Used LLMs to process 100k+ restaurant menus, reviews, and images across carbon footprint, nutrition, environment, hygiene, and dietary diversity; built a Sustainable Dining Index and ran spatiotemporal analysis of socioeconomic disparities in dining access across Hong Kong.

Streetscape Features and Home-Sharing Performance: Computer Vision & Spatiotemporal Modelling

- Extracted objective and perceptual features from 50k+ street-view images via semantic segmentation and deep learning; built spatiotemporal ML models to quantify streetscape effects on home-sharing performance.

PUBLICATIONS

Published — First Author

- [1] Zhao, Q., Li, H., Wang, B., Xu, P., & Jin, P. (2025). Unveiling dynamic determinants of tourism competitiveness: analysis integrating multimodal data and spatiotemporal machine learning. *Journal of Travel Research*. doi:10.1177/00472875251349239 (SSCI Q1, ABS 4, ABDC A*, CAS Q1 Top, IF-5 = 9.8)
- [2] Zhao, Q., Xu, P., Wang, B., Wu, S., Wu, M., & Jin, P. (2024). Does location affect the mechanism of tourism competitiveness? Evidence from machine-learning analysis. *Tourism Management Perspectives*, 53, 101291. doi:10.1016/j.tmp.2024.101291 (SSCI Q1, ABDC A*, CAS Q2 Top, IF-5 = 8.3)
- [3] Zhao, Q., Jin, P., Wang, B., & Xu, P. (2023). Evaluation of rural tourism competitiveness based on multisource data and machine learning: a case study of Lin'an District, Hangzhou. *Progress in Geography*, 42(8), 1541–1555. doi:10.18306/dlkxjz.2023.08.008 (CSSCI, CSCD)

Under Review — First Author

- [4] Zhao, Q., & Jin, P. Social inequalities in sustainable dining access across Hong Kong: a spatiotemporal analysis using multimodal data and large language models. *Cities*. (SSCI Q1, Nature Index, CAS Q1 Top, IF = 6.6, Under Review)
- [5] Zhao, Q., & Jin, P. Do street-view characteristics matter for home-sharing performance? A spatiotemporal machine-learning analysis. *Applied Geography*. (SSCI Q1, CAS Q1 Top, IF = 5.4, Under Review)

Co-authored — Journal Articles

- [6] Wang, B., Zhao, Q., Zhang, Z., Xu, P., Tian, X., & Jin, P. (2025). Understanding the heterogeneity and dynamics of factors influencing tourist sentiment with online reviews. *Journal of Theoretical and Applied Electronic Commerce Research*, 20(1), 22. doi:10.3390/jtaer20010022 (SSCI Q2, CAS Q3, IF-5 = 5.1)

- [7] Zou, Y., **Zhao, Q.**, Wang, B., & Chen, G. (2025). Sentiment mining of online comments of sports venues: consumer satisfaction and its influencing factors. *PLoS One*, 20(5), e0319476. doi:10.1371/journal.pone.0319476 (SCI Q2, CAS Q3, IF-5 = 3.2)
- [8] Xu, P., Zhou, G., **Zhao, Q.**, Lu, Y., & Chen, J. (2024). Spatial-temporal dynamics and influencing factors of city-level carbon emission of mainland China. *Ecological Indicators*, 167, 112672. doi:10.1016/j.ecolind.2024.112672 (SCI Q1, CAS Q1 Top, IF-5 = 7.2)
- [9] Qi, D., Wang, B., **Zhao, Q.**, & Jin, P. (2024). Research on the spatial network structure of tourist flows in Hangzhou based on BERT-BiLSTM-CRF. *ISPRS International Journal of Geo-Information*, 13(4), 139. doi:10.3390/ijgi13040139 (SCI Q2, CAS Q3, IF-5 = 3.3)

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

IPAS 2025 — Int'l Conference on Planetary Actions for Sustainability University of Tokyo, Japan Poster	Nov. 2025
APacCHRIE 2025 — Asia Pacific Council on Hotel, Restaurant & Institutional Education Chiang Mai University, Thailand Oral	May 2025
IMPACT 2025 — International Symposium Hong Kong Polytechnic University Oral	Nov. 2024
National Tourism Geography Annual Conference Guangzhou, China Oral	Aug. 2024
National Human Geography Conference Shaanxi Normal University Oral	Aug. 2023
Zhejiang Geographical Society Annual Conference Zhejiang University Oral	Oct. 2022

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Peer reviewer:

- **Annals of Tourism Research** (SSCI JCR Q1) — 2 reviews
- **Tourism Management** (SSCI JCR Q1) — 1 review
- **International Journal of Hospitality Management** (SSCI JCR Q1) — 1 review
- **Journal of Retailing and Consumer Services** (SSCI JCR Q1) — 3 reviews
- **Tourism Management Perspectives** (SSCI JCR Q1) — 1 review
- **Ecological Indicators** (SCI JCR Q1) — 1 review
- **Scientific Reports** (SCI JCR Q1) — 2 reviews

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

President — Graduate Student Union, School of Earth Sciences, ZJU – Led a 30+ member council; organised 20+ academic and cultural events; liaised between students and faculty.	Sep. 2022 – Sep. 2023
Group Leader — Summer Social Practice Programme, ZJU – Led a 300+ student volunteer team delivering online rural teaching to high-school students at Changhua High School, Lin'an, Hangzhou.	Jun. 2020 – Sep. 2020

AWARDS & HONORS

National Scholarship for PhD Students, Zhejiang University	2025
Outstanding Doctoral Dissertation Support Grant, Zhejiang University	2025
Qishui Rising Star PhD Fellowship, Zhejiang University	2025
Guo Xie Birong Scholarship, Zhejiang University	2023
Youth Excellent Paper Award, Geographical Society of Zhejiang Province	2022
Outstanding Bachelor Graduate, Zhejiang University	2022
Second Prize, 11th National Red Tourism Planning Competition (East China)	2021
Five-Star Volunteer, Zhejiang University	2021
Outstanding Individual in Summer Social Practice, Zhejiang University	2020
Outstanding Student, Zhejiang University	2019, 2021

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Programming & GIS: Python (Pandas, Scikit-learn, PyTorch, TensorFlow), Stata, ArcGIS, QGIS

Methods: Machine learning, spatiotemporal modelling, multimodal data analysis, LLM applications

Languages: Chinese (native) | English (IELTS 7.0, CET-6 569) **Interests:** Fitness | Basketball | Boxing | Cooking | Baking